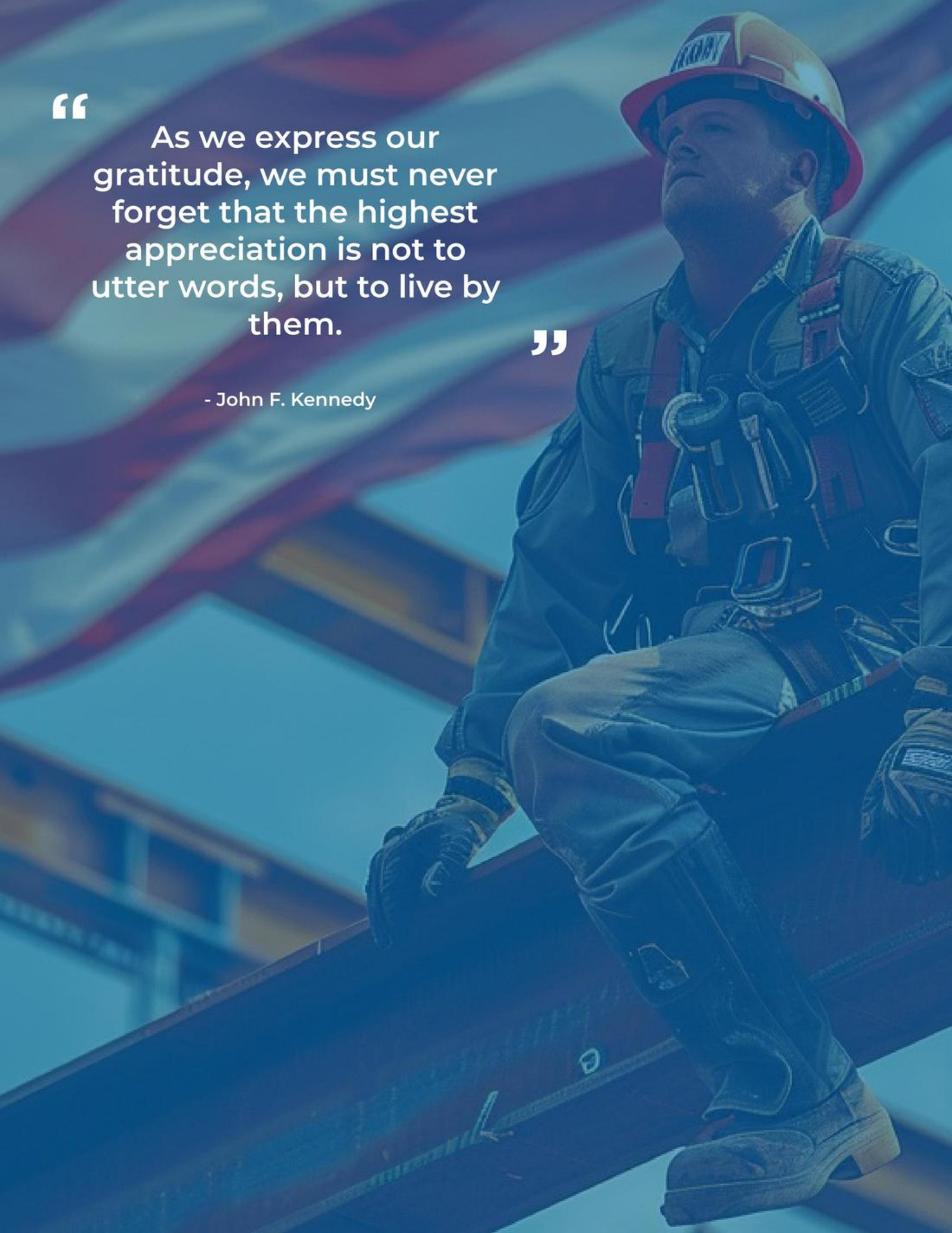


# VISTA UNPLUGGED

## SUMMER 2026


“
As we express our gratitude, we must never forget that the highest appreciation is not to utter words, but to live by them.
”
- John F. Kennedy

# A Message From Jeff

Dear friends,

As we step into the warmth of Summer, I want to begin this issue of UnPlugged by expressing my deepest gratitude. Thank you for your continued trust and partnership—whether you've been with us for years or just joined our community. Your confidence in our work inspires everything we do.

This summer feels especially meaningful as we draw closer to America's 250th birthday on July 4th. Two and a half centuries ago, a bold group of dreamers declared their independence and planted the seeds of the greatest experiment in human freedom the world has ever known. That spirit of resilience, innovation, and optimism still defines our nation today. In a world that often feels divided, I find myself filled with genuine pride in what America has achieved—and even greater hope for what lies ahead.

I also want to share my strong conviction that the coming years present significant opportunity in the markets. Despite periodic volatility and headlines that try to shake our confidence, the fundamental strength of American enterprise remains intact. Innovation is flourishing, businesses are adapting, and the long-term trajectory continues to reward patient, disciplined investors. I am genuinely optimistic about the road ahead.

Thank you again for allowing me to be part of your financial journey. I look forward to sharing some insights, analysis, and opportunities with you in the pages that follow.

Here's to a wonderful summer and an even brighter future.

With Gratitude,

**Jeff Speicher, AIF®**
**Founder - Managing Director**



JEFF SPEICHER
FINANCIAL ADVISOR

# VISTA UNPLUGGED NEWS

## What's Inside:


Suggested Reading Idea

A Family Baptism

Lighting Up Pittsburgh

Minor Roth IRAs

The U.S. Stock Market's Historic Bull Run

Recipe Corner



*Newsletter Disclosures*

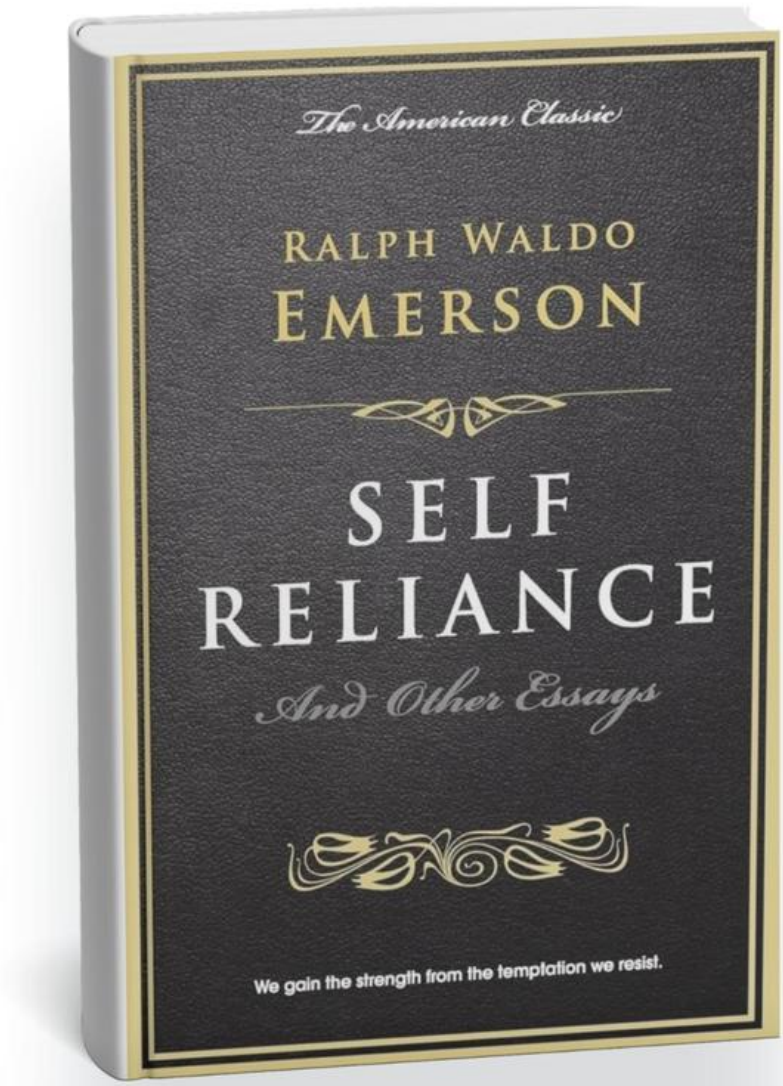
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# Summer Reading Idea




In an era dominated by social media echo chambers and short lived trends, Ralph Waldo Emerson's 1841 essay Self-Reliance stands as a timeless beacon for trusting your inner voice. This pillar of American Spiritualism urges us to shun conformity and chart genuine paths—principles that resonate with the disciplined, self-directed mindset of our clients. For those quietly amassing wealth and purpose, Emerson's insights provide a blueprint for authentic success.

**Who Was Emerson?**

Born in 1803, Ralph Waldo Emerson was a pioneering philosopher and essayist who profoundly influenced American intellectual life. A former Unitarian minister, he resigned in 1832 to embrace a wider exploration of spirituality and personal freedom. As a leader of the Transcendentalist movement, he emphasized intuition and self-discovery, inspiring figures like Henry David Thoreau and Walt Whitman. Self-Reliance, his most iconic essay, serves as a bold declaration for living life on your own terms.

**The Essence of Self-Reliance**

At its heart, Emerson's message is straightforward yet transformative: "Trust thyself." He contends that every individual possesses a divine inner spark, enabling us to discern truth through personal intuition. These core tenets align seamlessly with the independence cherished by wealth-builders:

- **Defy Conformity:** Emerson views society as a "joint-stock company" conspiring against individuality. He advocates nonconformity—not mere rebellion, but steadfast allegiance to your unique perspective, akin to the understated determination of those who sidestep fleeting investment fads.
- **Evolve Fearlessly:** "A foolish consistency is the hobgoblin of little minds." True growth requires discarding obsolete ideas, a concept well-known to savvy entrepreneurs and investors who pivot strategically amid change.
- **Act with Purpose:** Self-reliance isn't abstract; it's actionable. Emerson celebrates those who forge ahead in investments, ventures, or personal ethics, unbound by external validation.
- **Find Inner Fulfillment:** By trusting yourself, you connect with a deeper universal truth, cutting through the clutter of outside influences.

Emerson's lyrical writing, brimming with memorable adages like "Nothing is at last sacred but the integrity of your own mind," provokes both introspection and decisive action.

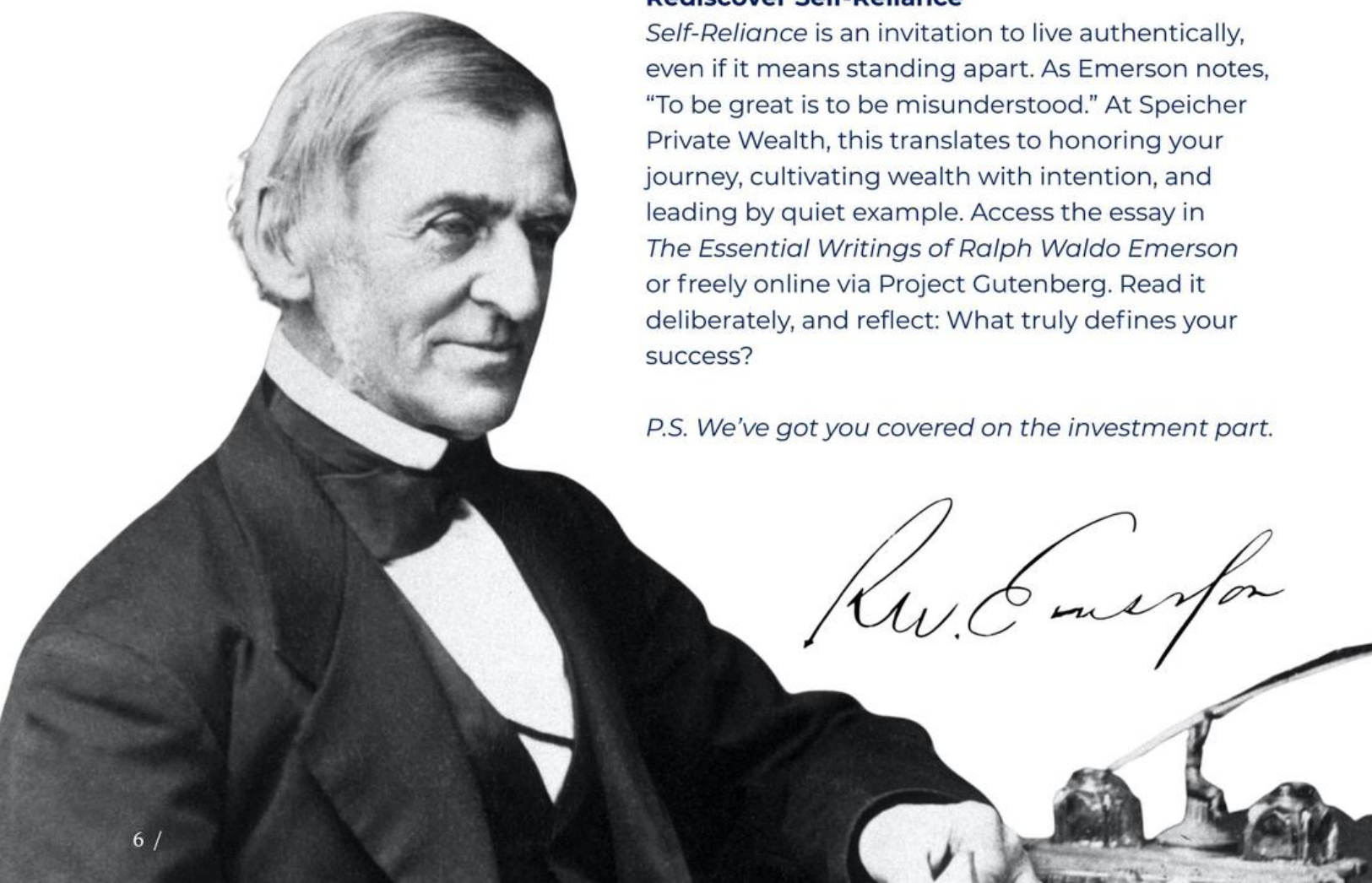
**Why It Matters in 2026**

In today's hyper-connected world, Self-Reliance pierces the digital haze. Platforms like social media foster herd mentality, while consumerism ties success to superficial displays. Emerson's insistence on internal validation—measuring achievement by **purpose** rather than praise—echoes our clients' commitment to quiet, principled prosperity. His philosophy equips you to remain anchored to your objectives, whether expanding a portfolio or navigating economic shifts.

**Living Self-Reliance**

To integrate Emerson's wisdom into daily life, consider these practical steps:

1. **Trust Your Instincts:** In financial or personal decisions, pause to consult your core values. Journaling can sharpen this inner clarity.
2. **Challenge Norms:** Resist societal urges to splurge or overextend. Prioritize what advances your enduring vision.
3. **Embrace Evolution:** Flexibly adjust strategies as markets evolve or priorities change, without clinging to outdated paths.
4. **Act Boldly:** Pursue calculated risks—initiate a new enterprise, rebalance assets, or establish clear boundaries.



**Rediscover Self-Reliance**

*Self-Reliance* is an invitation to live authentically, even if it means standing apart. As Emerson notes, "To be great is to be misunderstood." At Speicher Private Wealth, this translates to honoring your journey, cultivating wealth with intention, and leading by quiet example. Access the essay in *The Essential Writings of Ralph Waldo Emerson* or freely online via Project Gutenberg. Read it deliberately, and reflect: What truly defines your success?

*P.S. We've got you covered on the investment part.*

# A Family Baptism: Signs, Surrender, and Something Deeper

Our kids, Wes and Tyrsa, attended Saint Columba Catholic School right here in Durango. Faith has always been woven into the fabric of our lives, but like so many busy families, we often let the most important moments slip through the cracks.

A few years ago, our son Wes told us he wanted to be baptized. We fully intended to make it happen, but the weeks turned into months and then years. Then last fall, while I was preparing to visit Dallas for our CONNECT Conference, Tyrsa asked me to stay an extra couple days. When I arrived, I discovered she had found a church and was being baptized that Sunday. It was a deeply emotional experience, and I'm forever grateful I was there to witness it.

When I returned home, Wes's earlier request weighed heavily on my heart. I knew it was finally time to act.

Wes has been racing BMX at a national level for over a decade. One of his longtime coaches and mentors is Bubba Harris—a 15-time world champion who also serves as a youth minister in Phoenix. I reached out to Bubba and asked if we could arrange Wes's baptism over Easter weekend. He was immediately on board.

A week before Easter, we were driving to Rocky Point, Mexico, for Wes' spring break. Thess and I were listening to a podcast when the topic of adult baptism came up. I had been baptized as a baby in the Methodist church, but I found myself wondering: what if there's something especially powerful about making that choice as an adult—with full awareness and intention?

The following morning, we crossed the border and headed down the familiar 45-mile stretch of empty desert between the border and Rocky Point. In fifteen years of making that drive, we had never seen a single animal along that road. Then, halfway through, all four of us looked out the window at the exact same moment and saw something unforgettable: a brilliant white bull running alone through the desert. No herd. No cowboys. No explanation. For a moment we were speechless. Then I asked, "Did you all see that?"

We talked it over, and when we got home, I called Bubba again. New arrangements were made for both Wes and me. When I told Thess, she looked at me and said, "What about me?"

Before we knew it, the plan had expanded. The three of us—Thess, Wes, and I—were heading to Phoenix together. Tyrsa was flying in to witness her brother and the rest of her family take this step.

We arrived in Phoenix and visited CCV Church on Saturday night to meet with Bubba. I expected a short conversation and some simple preparation. Instead, we stepped into a service where the entire sermon was centered on baptism. I've heard many Easter sermons over the years, but this one hit differently—like it was prepared just for us.

During the service, Bubba quietly leaned over and said, "You know... we could do this right now." What happened next became one of the most meaningful nights of our lives. First Bubba and



Tyrsa baptized Wes, then our kids baptized Thess and I.  It was spontaneous, deeply personal, and profoundly moving. I still get emotional thinking about it.

I'm sharing this story not to preach, but simply because it's real and personal, just like the relationships we value so much with our clients.  Many of you reading this are Christians. Some are Jewish. Others are agnostic or somewhere in between. One of the things I've always valued most about serving you is our ability to come from different backgrounds while respecting one another's paths toward intentional, grounded lives. It's what gives my chosen career purpose.

This experience reminded me that the most important things rarely fit neatly into our busy schedules. They happen when we finally stop making excuses and say yes. Sometimes a white bull appears in the desert. Sometimes the right sermon finds you at exactly the right time. And sometimes your whole family ends up in the water together on a Saturday night in Arizona.

I hope our picture brings a bit of that moment to you. Wishing you signs, clarity, and the courage to follow through on what matters most.

Unplugged and grateful, Jeff




*Right to left: Tyrsa, Thess, Wes, Jeff, & Bubba*

# Lighting Up Pittsburgh: Celebrating America's 250th with the Zambelli Family Fireworks

A few years ago, Wes and I were in Pittsburgh for the Stars and Stripes BMX Nationals and discovered something truly special — the magic of a Zambelli fireworks show lighting up the night sky. This year, for America's 250th birthday, Thess and I are bringing both our kids back to celebrate with some of my best high school friends.

July 4th has always been my favorite holiday — a day that stirs deep pride in my heart for this extraordinary nation. Every year as a kid, we'd sit on the hill next to my grandmother's home to watch the fireworks, and even now we go out of our way to see them wherever we travel. We've been lucky enough to catch amazing displays in Barcelona, Medellín, DC, and of course Silverton is always special — but the show in Pittsburgh takes the cake.

I grew up in Lancaster County, but I've always felt right at home in Pittsburgh, a city that embodies American resilience, grit, and joy. We're heading back to the Steel City to celebrate in grand fashion. We'll feast on pierogies and cheesesteaks, soak in the vibrant hometown energy, and gather by the river where the Allegheny, Monongahela, and Ohio Rivers converge at Point State Park. As the sky erupts in a breathtaking symphony of color and light, those brilliant bursts will come from the Zambelli family — Pittsburgh's First Family of Fireworks.

**From Italy to New Castle**

In the hills just north of Pittsburgh lies New Castle, Pennsylvania — once known as the "Fireworks Capital of America." At the heart of that explosive legacy is the Zambelli family, whose pyrotechnic tradition spans more than 130 years and four generations. Their story is a classic American immigrant success tale, woven into the very fabric of our national celebrations.

The journey began in 1893 when Antonio Zambelli, a skilled fireworker from Naples, Italy, arrived on these shores carrying a small black notebook filled with his family's closely guarded pyrotechnic recipes. He settled in New Castle and founded the Zambelli Fireworks Manufacturing Company. His talent, paired with the ingenuity of fellow Italian immigrants, helped transform the region into a true powerhouse of American pyrotechnics.

**A Family Affair**

What started as one man's dream became a proud, multi-generational family enterprise. After Antonio's death in 1957, George Zambelli Sr. took the helm, incorporating Zambelli Fireworks Internationale in 1960 and expanding their reach while keeping the business proudly family-owned. Today, George Zambelli

Jr., M.D. (Antonio's grandson) leads the company, with the fourth generation — including George III and Jared — carrying the torch forward. This rare commitment reflects the very best of American values: hard work, tradition, and passing the flame of freedom to the next generation.

**Lighting Up History — and America's Skies**

The Zambellis have helped illuminate some of the greatest moments in American history:

- Fireworks for every U.S. president since John F. Kennedy, including spectacular displays from the White House South Lawn. I'm sure this year's show will be something truly special!
- Pittsburgh's own 250th anniversary in 2008, featuring a record 17 launch positions, nearly 40,000 effects, and a stunning waterfall off the West End Bridge.
- Annual shows for the Pittsburgh Pirates and Steelers that electrify hometown crowds.
- Iconic national spectacles like the Statue of Liberty centennial, Thunder Over Louisville, Mount Rushmore, and Times Square.

They've even set Guinness World Records, such as launching fireworks from the top of Pittsburgh's U.S. Steel Tower. Year after year, the Zambellis deliver innovation, craftsmanship, and safety while igniting our shared American spirit.

**A Pittsburgh Tradition**

For generations of Western Pennsylvanians, a Zambelli fireworks display is pure patriotism in the sky. Whether it's dazzling bursts over the Three Rivers on the Fourth of July or a thunderous finale at PNC Park, their work brings communities together in awe and unity. The Speicher family is so ready!

This 250th anniversary of American independence feels especially powerful. As we reunite with high school friends — we haven't seen in years — we'll stand along the riverfront with plates of pierogies and cheesesteaks in hand, hearts full of gratitude, watching the night sky explode in red, white, and blue. In that moment, we won't just be celebrating fireworks — we'll be honoring the enduring promise of liberty, opportunity, and the American Dream that brought Antonio Zambelli here and continues to inspire us all.

The Zambelli motto lives on: to create not just explosions, but lasting memories in the sky. On this historic Independence Day, that's exactly what we'll be doing — proudly, joyfully, and together as one nation under the stars.

# Minor Roth IRAs: Giving Your Kids a Decades-Long Head Start on Wealth



In a world obsessed with instant gratification, one of the most powerful financial moves you can make for your children is profoundly simple: starting them early in a Roth IRA. A custodial (or "minor") Roth IRA lets kids with earned income begin building tax-free wealth that can compound for 50, 60, or even 70+ years. It's not just smart retirement planning—it's one of the best ways to teach real financial responsibility while the power of time works in their favor.

**What Is a Custodial Roth IRA?**
A custodial Roth IRA is a Roth Individual Retirement Account owned by the child but managed by a parent, guardian, or other adult until the child reaches the age of majority (usually 18 or 21, depending on the state). Contributions are made with after-tax dollars, but qualified withdrawals—including all earnings—are entirely tax-free in retirement.

The key requirement is simple: the child must have earned income in the year contributions are made. This includes wages from a formal job (like lifeguarding or retail), or self-employment income from activities like babysitting, lawn mowing, pet sitting, or even modeling/acting gigs. Allowances, gifts, or investment income don't count.

There's no minimum age. Even young children with qualifying income (think child actors) can have one.

**Contribution Rules for 2026**

- **2026:** Up to $7,500 or the child's total earned income, whichever is less.

Anyone can contribute to the account (parents, grandparents, etc.), as long as the total doesn't exceed the child's earned income for that year. For kids in low or zero tax brackets, this is especially efficient—the "tax" paid on contributions is minimal or nonexistent.

Roth IRAs also have income phase-outs, but these rarely apply to minors.

**The Magic: Time + Tax-Free Compounding**
The real advantage is decades of uninterrupted growth. A single $1,000 contribution at age 15, growing at a conservative 7% annually, could exceed $15,000 by age 65—or far more with ongoing contributions.

Unlike a 529 college savings plan, funds in a Roth IRA aren't restricted to education. Contributions (the original money put in) can be withdrawn penalty- and tax-free at any time for any purpose. Earnings have more restrictions but can be accessed penalty-free for qualified education expenses or a first home purchase (with limits).

**How to Open**
Short answer is call us. We will want you to check with your CPA about documenting the child's income. Often times a notebook listing payments for mowing, dishes, or washing the car if needed. From there, we can open the account and help you invest.

As custodian, you control investments and decisions until the child takes over. Use this period for financial education—explain compounding, risk, and patience.

**Benefits Beyond Retirement**
- Financial literacy: Hands-on learning about investing.
- Tax-free growth: Ideal for those expecting higher future tax rates.
- Flexibility: More versatile than many education-specific accounts.
- Legacy building: Sets kids up with a serious nest egg early.

**Potential Drawbacks to Consider**
- Irrevocable gifts: Once contributed, the money belongs to the child. At majority, they gain full control and could withdraw or mismanage it if they know about it.
- Financial aid impact: Assets in the child's name can affect college aid eligibility more than parent-owned accounts.
- Recordkeeping: Tracking earned income properly is important for IRS compliance.
- Opportunity cost: Money in a Roth can't be used as freely as a regular savings account during childhood.

**Is It Right for Your Family?**
If your child has (or can generate) even modest earned income, a Minor Roth IRA is hard to beat for long-term wealth building. It's not about pushing kids into the workforce early but about redirecting existing earnings (or family-supported work) toward their future self.

In an "unplugged" approach to life, this is patient capital at its finest: quiet, compounding, and detached from daily market noise or status-driven spending. Start small, stay consistent, and let time do the heavy lifting.

## Your kids *(and their older selves)* will thank you!

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# The U.S. Stock Market's Historic Bull Run

As of mid-2026, the U.S. stock market continues to defy skeptics. The S&P 500 has posted strong gains, supported by AI enthusiasm, resilient corporate earnings, and a cautious Federal Reserve. The current bull market, which started in October 2022, has now entered its fourth year and ranks among the longer bull markets in modern history. While not yet the longest on record, it has delivered impressive returns and still shows potential for further upside.

**Defining a Bull Market and Historical Context** A bull market is typically defined as a 20%+ increase in major indices like the S&P 500 from recent lows. Historically, bull markets have averaged around 4–5 years, though some have lasted much longer during periods of major technological advancement or supportive economic conditions. The current cycle is approaching the upper end of typical durations but has demonstrated notable resilience.

**Current State in 2026** The rally has been powered by technology leadership, broadening earnings growth beyond just Big Tech, and the economy's adaptability. Analysts expect continued but more moderated gains ahead, with risks centered on elevated valuations and external shocks. AI-related companies remain the primary drivers of recent performance.

**How Long Can Bull Markets Last?** Bull markets usually end because of recessions, monetary tightening, major shocks, or overvaluation — not simply because of age. Entering its fourth year, this bull market has historical precedent for continuation, especially if corporate earnings, innovation, and supportive conditions persist. On average, fourth-year performance has been positive.

**The Role of Oil Prices and Stabilization** Oil price volatility tied to geopolitical tensions has added to inflationary pressures this year. However, if prices stabilize at moderate levels (forecasts often point to $50–70 per barrel), it would lower input costs for businesses, ease the burden on consumers, and act as a significant tailwind for non-energy sectors — potentially helping extend the bull market.

**How Inflation Influences Markets** As of April 2026, inflation stands around 3.8% year-over-year — above the Fed's 2% target but well below 2022 peaks. Moderate inflation (in the 2–4% range) can actually support stock prices by enabling nominal revenue growth, serving as an asset hedge, and keeping real interest rates relatively accommodative. If oil prices stabilize and prevent aggressive rate hikes, this environment remains equity-friendly.

**We're Still Warming Up in the Batting Cage on the AI Trade** A key reason this bull market could run longer than average is that the AI investment and adoption cycle is still in its early stages.



# How Long Can It Last, Especially as Oil Prices Stabilize?

Think of it like baseball players in the batting cage: companies are taking powerful swings with heavy capital expenditure and hype, but the real game — widespread economic transformation and sustained productivity gains — hasn't fully started yet.

Key indicators of the early phase include:

- **Massive investment with lagging impact:** Big Tech alone plans roughly $600–700 billion in capex for 2026, mostly for data centers, chips, and power. Yet overall productivity growth remains modest so far, similar to the "Solow Paradox" of the 1980s–90s.
- **Widespread but shallow adoption:** Most firms have begun investing, but many are still in pilot phases. Task-level improvements (e.g., 40–55% gains in coding or writing) are real, but full organizational integration, workforce retraining, and economy-wide effects are just beginning.
- **Long runway ahead:** Analysts project AI could add 1–7%+ to GDP over the next decade, with peak productivity boosts likely in the early 2030s. Major infrastructure waves are expected through 2028–2030.

This extended timeline suggests the AI trade still has significant room to deliver earnings growth and support the market for years to come.

**Outlook and Investor Considerations** The bull market has room to run and could become one of the longer ones in history if AI-driven productivity gains, earnings growth, oil stabilization, and moderate inflation align favorably. A fourth consecutive year of positive returns remains plausible.

**Key Risks:** Elevated valuations, geopolitical shocks, unexpected policy shifts, or delayed AI returns that could trigger a correction. **Investor Advice:** Diversify across sectors with exposure to AI and inflation resilience. Focus on quality companies with strong fundamentals, pricing power, and clear adoption paths. Treat market pullbacks as potential buying opportunities, while maintaining a long-term perspective. As always, consult a financial professional, since past performance is no guarantee of future results.

The U.S. stock market's resilience demonstrates the economy's adaptability. Its longevity will ultimately depend on successfully navigating inflation, energy dynamics, and the still-early AI revolution — where we're very much still warming up in the batting cage, with plenty of upside swings potentially ahead.

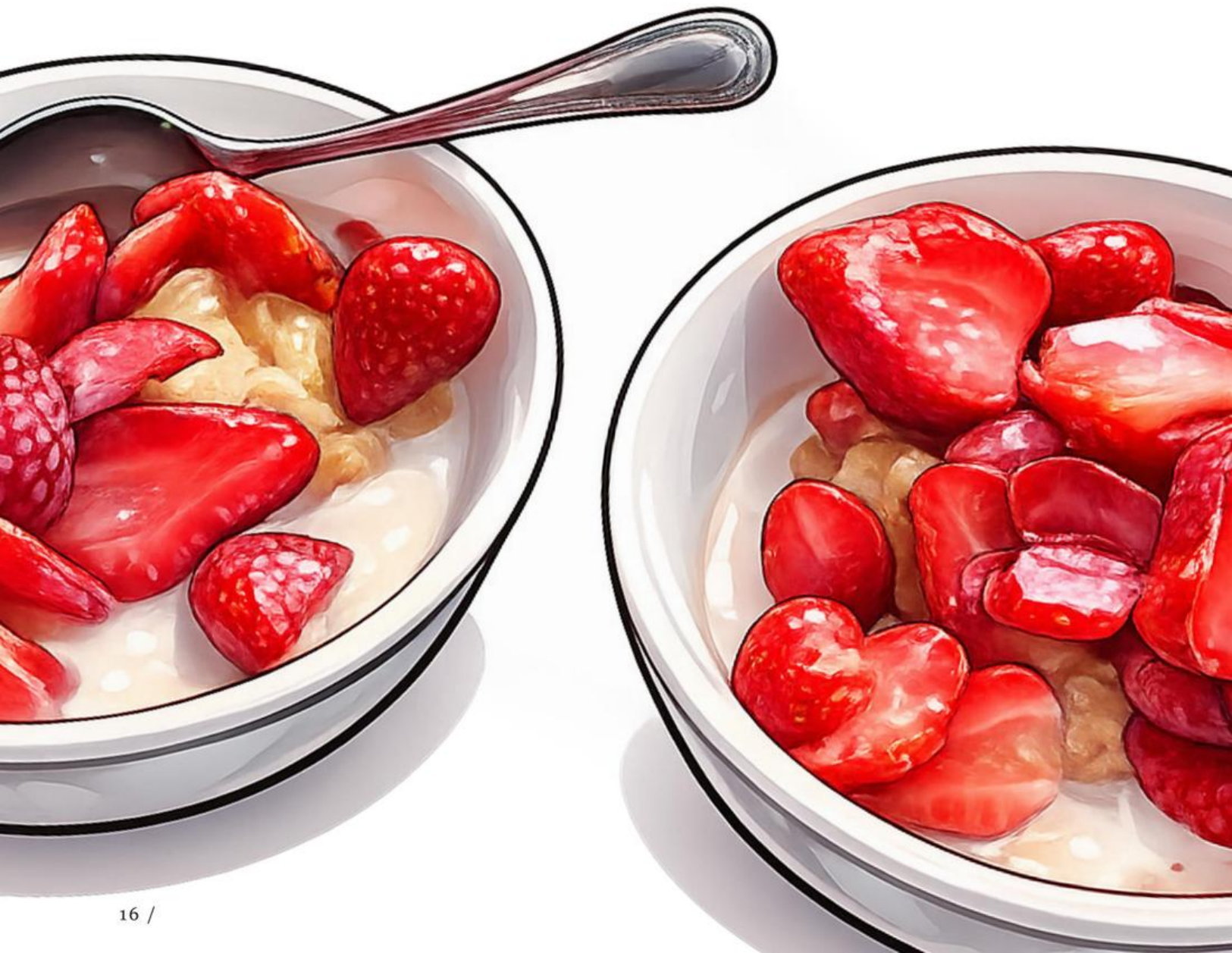
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# Mom's Strawberry Shortcake: A Taste of Summer and Family Love

Some desserts are more than sweet—they're full of memories and home. For me, that's Mom's Strawberry Shortcake. This simple classic has been a family favorite for decades. One bite takes me back to sunny summer days, backyard parties, and pure joy.

What makes Mom's version special is its beautiful simplicity. Just Bisquick, fresh strawberries, and a few pantry staples. It comes together fast, perfect for weeknights or last-minute celebrations. It also holds a cherished place in our family story: it was the centerpiece at my brother's wedding instead of a traditional cake. Guests loved it, and every bite was filled with love and celebration.

Why This Recipe Feels Like Summer Strawberry shortcake is summer on a plate—juicy, sun-ripened berries, tender biscuits, and clouds of whipped cream. Refreshing yet indulgent, it's the dessert you crave after a lake day or backyard barbecue. One forkful and I'm back in Mom's kitchen, watching her slice strawberries while biscuits baked golden.



# Mom's Easy Strawberry Shortcake Recipe

*Serves: 6–8 Prep time: 15 minutes Cook time: 10–12 minutes*

## Ingredients

Strawberries:

- 2 pounds fresh strawberries, hulled and sliced
- ⅓ cup granulated sugar (adjust to taste)

Shortcakes (Bisquick):

- 2⅓ cups Bisquick baking mix
- 3 tablespoons granulated sugar
- ⅓ cup cold butter, cut into small pieces
- ½ cup milk
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract (optional)

For serving:

- Whipped cream (fresh or Cool Whip)
- Extra strawberries for garnish
- Optional: powdered sugar, and Milk *(I always pour milk over mine)*

## Instructions

1. Prepare strawberries: Mix sliced strawberries with sugar. Let sit 20–30 minutes to create a juicy syrup.
2. Make shortcakes: Preheat oven to 425°F (220°C). Stir Bisquick and sugar together. Cut in cold butter until crumbly. Add milk and vanilla; stir just until combined.
3. Bake: Drop dough by heaping spoonfuls onto an ungreased baking sheet (6–8 shortcakes). Bake 10–12 minutes until golden. Cool slightly.
4. Assemble: Split warm shortcakes in half. Spoon strawberries and syrup on the bottom, add whipped cream, then the top half. Finish with more strawberries and cream. Garnish with a fresh berry.

Serve immediately while the biscuits are warm. The contrast of buttery shortcake, cold cream, and juicy berries is pure magic.

## Tips from Mom's Kitchen

- Use the ripest strawberries possible—farmers market or garden-picked are best.
- Brush biscuit tops with milk and sprinkle with sugar before baking for a sparkly crust.
- Scales easily for crowds.
- Store components separately—biscuits get soggy if assembled too early.

This strawberry shortcake is more than a recipe—it's a family tradition. It's what I request for birthdays, and it still brings back the joy of my brother's wedding. Every time I make it, I feel Mom's love in the kitchen.

Try it this summer. It just might become your new favorite too. *Happy baking!*



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